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More issues detailed at assisted living home

Inspections reveal lack of safety preparations

By Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF
and Bryan Hecht
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Inadequate training. A lack of safety protocols. Poor guidance for staff. And an HVAC system that continued to pump out uncomfortably warm air even after a woman died in a room where temperatures neared 100 degrees.

New information from inspection reports and interviews Friday detailed ongoing failures at the assisted living residence in Hopkinton where an 86-year-old resident was found dead in her sweltering room on Sept. 30. Also on Friday, state regulators barred the facility, the Communities at Golden Pond, from accepting new residents for now.

An inspection by state officials on Tuesday — the second in three weeks at Golden Pond since the death of the resident — found yet more problems that ranged beyond the heating and cooling system: The residence failed to meet several training standards for staff, including for emergency preparedness; lacked documentation that residents who needed assistance getting in and out of bed were properly assessed; and did not complete a review of its operations as required.

ASSISTED LIVING, Page A6

Leaders in arts, science, business take a look ahead

Globe Summit seeks path to thriving future

By Nick Stoico
GLOBE STAFF

From artificial intelligence and higher education to health care and the arts, some of the biggest issues facing New England will take center stage at the Boston Globe's sixth annual Globe Summit in November.

Inspired by the nation's 250th anniversary, this year's summit is themed "Built to Last," bringing together leaders in politics, business, and the arts to share ideas for building a thriving future in the region.

The summit, now in its sixth year, will take place Tuesday, Nov. 17, and Wednesday, Nov. 18, at the House of Blues in Boston and will stream online. The first day will focus on health and leadership, followed by innovation and culture on day two. (Tickets are available at Globe.com/summit.)

"Our journalists are at the heart of Globe Summit, bringing their reporting and expertise to life through meaningful conversations with the people shaping our region," Globe editor Brian McGrory said in a statement.

"We're so proud of this event," said

SUMMIT, Page A7

Cannabis foes' ads raise questions

Researchers say claims citing increased danger on roads rely on limited data

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

The campaign behind a ballot question to overturn legal marijuana sales in Massachusetts put out a blitz of advertisements this month hooked on a bold insinuation: Today's recreational cannabis market makes the roads more dangerous.

Supporters of Question 8 cast a projection on a Brookline apartment complex that read: "42% of drivers in fatal crashes test positive for THC," the intoxicating compound in weed. A corresponding TV spot cited the statistic. The campaign's website blares "DUIs RISING" and tucks a flurry of incriminating statistics underneath.

The problem?

Not all of that is exactly true, and some of the data isn't even about Massachusetts.

The "Coalition for a Healthy Massachusetts" behind Question 8 is leaning heavily on research out of Ohio, and other questionable claims about road safety, in its bid to dismantle the state's adult-use weed market through the November ballot measure.

Lucy Xiaolu Wang, a University of Massachusetts Amherst professor who has studied cannabis, said drawing conclusions from the out-of-state study cited by the "Yes on 8" campaign is "impossible," because there have been so few conclusive scientific inquiries into impaired driving from drugs other than alcohol.

Proponents of legal weed in Massachusetts are not arguing that it's safe to drive while high, and the behavior itself is forbidden by state law. But Wang and other experts say the 42 percent figure at the heart of the "Yes" campaign's claim ignores crucial context: Only 21 clinical trials related to THC and driving have been conducted since 2000 across the country, according to a tracker kept by the National Library of Medicine.

Most do not meet the gold stan-

DRIVING, Page A6

'This is a community path, and our priority is the slowest-moving users.'

BRAD RAWSON, *Somerville's head of transportation and infrastructure*



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

A bicyclist rode over rumble strips on the Somerville Community Path at the Cedar Street intersection.

Somerville sounds a warning to speeders on bike path

Rumble strips, new signs aim to slow down electric bikes, scooters

By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

SOMERVILLE — *Bump, bump, bump, bump, bump.*

Bikers, e-bikers, bucket bikers, scooter and e-moto riders, and anyone else zipping down this city's shared-use path will find some new infrastructure rattling their chassis, wrists, and ankles this fall.

Somerville over the past few weeks has been adding "rumble strips" to the otherwise smooth pavement lining the Somerville Community Path, a passageway popular with commuters, pedestrians, dog-walkers, and kids.

It's an effort city leaders hope can blunt the impact of one- and two-wheeled electric vehicles, whose riders sometimes treat paths like highways, frightening the slower walkers, bikers, and runners they whizz past.

"If you're strolling or jogging, or you've got kids, it can be really scary," said Ben Wheeler, a city councilor who serves on the city's traffic and parking committee. "If somebody doesn't realize someone's coming up fast and takes a step towards the middle of the path and ends up getting struck, they could get really hurt."

Somerville's 3.2-mile-long community path, including a 1.9-mile extension that opened in 2023, may be a victim of its own success.

A direct link through the center of the city to Boston on one end, and Cambridge's bike paths on the other, the path is fully separated from the hazards and headaches of car traffic. It's a favored route for commuters who might otherwise get where they need to by car. And it can get really busy: At peak times, some parts see as many as 500 people pass by each hour, city data show.

But it's proving a little *too* convenient, people who use the path say, for those who opt to use it at high speeds. Food delivery drivers on mopeds, high schoolers on what are essentially electric dirt bikes, or even just serious cyclists on performance bicycles, have made traveling on the path a sometimes hair-raising experience — even if city data show that few

BIKE PATH, Page A5

Set at home, lawmakers share their wealth



LOCAL SPENDING — In an advertisement urging support of Question 9 on the state ballot, Representative Jake Auchincloss assembled a replica rifle in real time. **B1.**

Mass. delegation backs colleagues across the US

By Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — In solidly blue Massachusetts, the incumbent federal lawmakers who had a competitive race for reelection dispensed with their challengers in the Sept. 1 primaries. So as November's midterm elections draw near, they've been spending their time — and money — elsewhere.

With the growing likelihood of Democrats flipping control of the House and possibly also taking the Senate, members of the state's congressional delegation have transferred roughly $2.5 million from their campaign accounts and political action committees to colleagues and candidates running across the country this year.

New England's prominent surrogates also have been in demand on the campaign trail, including Vermont Independent Senator Bernie Sanders, Massachusetts Senator Elizabeth Warren, Boston Representative Ayanna Pressley, and the No. 2 Democrat in the House, Representative Katherine Clark of Revere. They've made swings through battlegrounds in the final months of the election season. In recent months, they've

MIDTERMS, Page A7

The Trump administration asked a federal court to block certification of the Senate election in Alaska if the Republican incumbent narrowly loses, signaling an effort to potentially intervene in the outcome. **A2.**

Ukraine's top negotiator involved in a humanitarian mission led by US first lady Melania Trump said a local cease-fire with Russia will start Tuesday and last several days. **A3.**

Two Massachusetts State Police troopers were suspended with pay pending an investigation into a sexual assault that allegedly occurred at the State Police barracks on Martha's Vineyard. **B1.**



Twin suns

Saturday: Sunny, bright. High: 56-61. Low: 40-45.

Sunday: Sunny, warmer. High: 62-67. Low: 42-47.

Sunrise: 7:07 Sunset: 5:48

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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